



Sourav Majumdar (left), Editor, *Business Today*, with jury members (from left) **Arun Kumar Purwar**, former chairman of State Bank of India; **Alice G. Vaidyan**, former chairman & MD of GIC Re; **K.V. Kamath (Jury Chair)**, Chairperson, National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID); **Avinash Gupta**, MD & CEO, Dun & Bradstreet; and **A.P. Hota**, former MD & CEO of NPCI Ltd

payments and value-added spaces. The entire process of reaching out to banks and fintechs began in September 2022, and culminated in a jury meeting in early December.

The jury was presided over by K.V. Kamath, Chairperson of the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID). Other members were Arun Kumar Purwar, former chairman of State Bank of India (SBI); Alice G. Vaidyan, former chairman and MD of GIC Re; A.P. Hota, former MD & CEO of NPCI Ltd; and Avinash Gupta, MD & CEO of Dun & Bradstreet. In terms of conflict of interest, Hota disclosed that he is an independent director on the

board of The Federal Bank.

There were eight awards that the jury had to decide on. Two bank awards—Best Enterprise Resilience in Banks and Best Intellectual Property Protection and Management—were not put up before the jury because of a lack of adequate nominations.

The category of innovation had one of the highest responses ever, with 49 nominations. This year, there was also a shift in innovation initiatives from retail to MSMEs. Knowledge partner KPMG disclosed that they are advising Bank of Baroda on their digital transformation plan, where fintech initiatives are also a part. They have been involved with this programme for the past 30 months.

During a two-hour-long jury meeting over a working lunch, the members deliberated about the top candidates from the lens of influence they had on the financial system, client convenience, and future scalability. Recognising the role played by public sector banks, which work under numerous constraints, the jury decided to give a special award to the country's largest bank, SBI, for "consistent transformation". The jury was also unanimous in conferring the Lifetime Achievement Award to Arundhati Bhattacharya, former chairman of SBI; she is currently Chairperson & CEO of Salesforce India. Both ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank were strong competitors for the Bank of the Year award, and thus there was a lot of debate. The former was finally chosen due to the operational turnaround and stability of operations under MD & CEO Sandeep Bakhshi.

QUANTITATIVE AWARDS

For rankings based on pure financial performance, data was taken from published annual reports

of banks from FY19 to FY22. This year's survey covered 47 scheduled commercial banks that had published their annual reports or provided their annual reports at the time of conducting the survey prior to October 31, 2022. Scheduled commercial banks (except in case of Indian small finance banks) with a balance sheet size of less than ₹5,000 crore, and foreign banks with a balance sheet size of less than ₹25,000 crore as on March 31, 2022, were not considered. Also scheduled commercial banks whose financial statements were not available with us or which had not completed four years in India as on March 31, 2022, or were involved in mergers in the last three years or were under liquidation were not covered.

The ranking process

The banks were categorised as 'Indian banks' (both public and private banks), 'foreign banks' (branches of foreign banks operating in India) and 'Indian small finance banks'. Indian banks were further classified based on balance sheet size as on March 31, 2022.

Group I Banks with a balance sheet size of more than or equal to ₹3 lakh crore

Group II Banks with a balance sheet size of more than ₹1 lakh crore but less than ₹3 lakh crore

Group III Banks with a balance sheet size of less than or equal to ₹1 lakh crore

Group IV Foreign banks with a balance sheet size of more than or equal to ₹25,000 crore

Group V Indian small finance banks

Ranking parameters

The banks were judged on three parameters—growth, size and strength—divided into 34 sub parameters: